

Pakistan studies



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Chapter 4



In the name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Most Kind

Society And Culture Of Pakistan

TERMINOLOGIES

- **30 Easy Terminologies (Culture & People of Pakistan)**
- **Culture** – The way people live, think, eat, dress, and celebrate.
- **Society** – A group of people living together in a community.
- **Civilization** – A developed society with organized government and culture.
- **Religion** – Beliefs about God; Islam strongly influences life in Pakistan.
- **Islamic Values** – Moral teachings of Islam such as honesty, respect, and kindness.
- **Tradition** – Customs followed by people for a long time.
- **Customs** – Everyday social practices of a community.
- **Social Norms** – Rules of behavior accepted in society.
- **Family System** – The way families live together; joint families are common.
- **Respect for Elders** – Showing honor and obedience to older people.
- **Hospitality** – Welcoming and treating guests kindly.
- **Ethnic Group** – A group of people with the same culture and language.
- **Ethnic Diversity** – Many different ethnic groups living in one country.
- **Punjabis** – The largest ethnic group in Pakistan.
- **Sindhis** – People mainly living in Sindh province.

- **Pashtuns** – People living mainly in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.
- **Baloch** – People mainly living in Balochistan.
- **Saraiki** – A cultural group mainly in southern Punjab.
- **National Language** – Urdu, which connects people across Pakistan.
- **Regional Languages** – Languages like Punjabi, Sindhi, Pashto, and Balochi.
- **Unity in Diversity** – Different cultures living together as one nation.
- **Traditional Dress** – Shalwar Kameez, the national dress of Pakistan.
- **Folk Culture** – Local music, dances, and traditions of people.
- **Folk Music** – Traditional songs of different regions.
- **Handicrafts** – Handmade cultural items like carpets and embroidery.
- **Art and Calligraphy** – Islamic artistic writing and decoration.
- **Festivals** – Special days of celebration like Eid.
- **Cuisine** – Traditional foods such as biryani and sajji.
- **Cultural Heritage** – Traditions and history passed from past generations.
- **National Identity** – Feeling of belonging to Pakistan.

- **10 Most Important Sociology Terms:**

- **Society** – People living together with shared **culture and institutions**.
- **Culture** – Shared **beliefs, values, customs, and knowledge**.
- **Socialization** – Learning **norms, values, and behaviors** of society.
- **Social Facts** – **Rules and traditions** that control behavior. (*Durkheim*)
- **Collective Conscience** – Shared **beliefs and moral values** uniting society. (*Durkheim*)
- **Solidarity** – **Unity and cooperation** keeping society stable.
 - **Mechanical** – traditional societies
 - **Organic** – modern societies
- **Anomie** – Breakdown of **social norms causing instability**. (*Durkheim*)
- **Social Stratification** – **Hierarchy** based on wealth, status, or power.
- **Deviance** – Behavior that **violates social norms or laws**.
- **Social Change** – **Transformation** in society's culture, technology, or institutions.

The culture and people of Pakistan

Pakistani Culture :

- **Meaning:**

Pakistani culture is the **way of life of the people of Pakistan**, shaped mainly by **Islamic teachings, regional traditions, and historical influences**.

- **Main Features:**

1. Islamic Influence

- Islam is the **foundation of Pakistani culture**.
- It influences **values, social behavior, festivals, and moral life**. **Unity in Diversity**
- Pakistan has many ethnic groups such as **Punjabis, Sindhis, Pashtuns, Baloch, and Saraikis**.
- Each group has its **own language, dress, and customs**, but all share a common national culture.

3. Family System

- Pakistani society is **family-centered**.
- **Respect for elders, strong family bonds, and joint family system** are important traditions.

- **Hospitality:**
- **Guests are treated with great respect and generosity**, which is an important cultural value.
- **5. Dress and Traditions:**
- **Shalwar Kameez** is the national dress.
- Regional cultural symbols include **Sindhi Ajrak, Balochi embroidery, and Pashtun caps.**
- **6. Arts and Literature:**
- Pakistani culture includes **poetry, music, calligraphy, handicrafts, carpets, pottery, and truck art.**
- **7. Festivals and Food:**
- Major celebrations include **Eid-ul-Fitr and Eid-ul-Adha.**
- Famous foods include **biryani, nihari, sajji, and chapli kebab.**

Education in Pakistan

Education in Pakistan :

1. Introduction

- Education plays a vital role in the **social, economic, and political development of Pakistan**. It helps in building skilled human resources and promoting national unity.

2. Objectives of Education in Pakistan

- The main aims of education are:
- To promote **Islamic values and moral development**.
- To create **responsible and productive citizens**.
- To develop **scientific and technical knowledge**.
- To strengthen **national unity and identity**.

Structure of Education System:

The education system in Pakistan is generally divided into the following levels:

- **Pre-Primary Education**
 - Age: 3–5 years
 - Nursery and kindergarten classes.
- **Primary Education**
 - Classes: 1–5
 - Basic literacy and numeracy.
- **Middle Education**
 - Classes: 6–8
 - Introduction to different subjects.
- **Secondary Education**
 - Classes: 9–10
 - Students appear in **Secondary School Certificate (SSC)** examination.
- **Higher Secondary Education**
 - Classes: 11–12
 - Students receive **Higher Secondary School Certificate (HSSC)**.
- **Higher Education**
 - Universities and colleges offer **Bachelor's, Master's, and PhD degrees**.

Population density

Population of Pakistan:

- The current population of Pakistan is **about 26 crore/258 million people (2026 estimate)** (February **2026**) based on **United Nations population estimates**.
- Pakistan ranks **5th in the world** among the most populous countries.
- Pakistan's population accounts for **about 3.1% of the total world population**.
- The **population density** in Pakistan is approximately **336 people per square kilometer**.
- The **total land area** of Pakistan is **770,880 km²**.
- About **34.7% of the population lives in urban areas**.

Simple Definition:

- **Population density = Total population ÷ Total land area**

Example (Pakistan)

- **Population $\approx$ 258 million**
- **Land area = 770,880 km²**
- **Population density of Pakistan $\approx$ 336 people per km².**
- **This means on average about 336 people live in one square kilometer of land in Pakistan.**

Pakistan society and culture

Definition of Society:

- **“Society is a group of people who live together in a defined territory, share a common culture, interact with each other, and are bound by social relationships, norms, and institutions.”**

Key points :

- **Group of people** – Society is never about a single individual.
- **Territory** – People live in a common geographical area.
- **Common culture** – Shared language, values, beliefs, and customs.
- **Social interaction** – Members influence and depend on each other.
- **Social organization** – Structured through rules, norms, and institutions.

Pakistan society and culture

Structural–Functional Approach:

- **Idea:** Society is like a system where each part (family, school, religion, government) has a function to maintain stability.
- **Key Scholar:** Émile Durkheim:
- **Practical Life Examples:**
- **Family:** Provides emotional support, teaches values, and raises children who can contribute to society.
- **Schools:** Educate children to develop skills and prepare them for jobs, helping the economy.
- **Police and Courts:** Maintain law and order, ensuring social stability.
- **Religious Institutions:** Promote moral values, encouraging harmony among people.

Conflict Approach:

- **Idea:** Society is full of inequalities and conflicts because groups compete for **power, wealth, and resources**.
- **Key Scholar:** Karl Marx
- **Practical Life Examples:**
- **Workers vs. Employers:** Strikes or protests happen when workers feel exploited.
- **Political Parties:** Compete for votes and power, often leading to conflict in decision-making.
- **Gender Inequality:** Women fighting for equal pay or education opportunities.
- **Land Disputes:** Conflicts between rich landlords and poor farmers over ownership.

- **Pakistani Society:**

- Pakistani society is **multi-ethnic and multi-lingual**, composed of Punjabis, Sindhis, Baloch, Pashtuns, and other groups.
 - It is a **collectivist society**, meaning family, tribe, and community
- Characteristics:**

- **Strong family ties:** Extended families often live together.
 - **Religious influence:** Islam plays a central role in daily life, social norms, and laws.
 - **Social hierarchy:** Status is influenced by wealth, caste, tribe, and education.
 - **Patriarchal system:** Traditionally, men hold authority in the household and society.
 - The society is **largely rural**, though urbanization is increasing in cities like Karachi, Lahore, and Islamabad.

Males in Pakistani Society:

- **Family & Economy:** Traditionally the **breadwinner**, responsible for earning income and providing for family needs.
- **Decision-Making:** Major decisions in family, politics, and business are usually taken by men.
- **Protection & Authority:** Men are expected to protect the family and uphold social honor.
- **Public Life:** More active in politics, education, and professional sectors.
- **Example:** A father supporting his children's education while making family financial and social decisions.

Roles of Females in Pakistani Society:

- **Family & Household:** Traditionally manage the **home, children, and domestic responsibilities.**
- **Education & Profession:** Urban women increasingly participate in **education, healthcare, and Current Trends & Changes**
- More women are **attending schools, universities, and workplaces.**
- **Gender roles are slowly changing,** especially in cities, with women entering politics, law, medicine, and business.
- **Media and technology** are influencing younger generations to adopt more egalitarian roles.

Professional work.

- **Cultural & Religious Role:** Women often transmit **cultural values and religious teachings** to children.
- **Social Influence:** Women influence family decisions indirectly, though patriarchal norms limit direct authority.
- **Example:** A mother raising children, teaching moral values, and contributing to family budgeting

Pakistan Languages and Literature

Languages of Pakistan:

1. Introduction

- Pakistan is a **multilingual country** where many regional and local languages are spoken. Linguistic diversity reflects the **ethnic, cultural, and historical variety** of the country. According to census data, more than **70 languages** are spoken in Pakistan, but a few major languages dominate the population.
- Most Pakistani languages belong to the **Indo-Aryan and Iranian branches of the Indo-European language family**, while some belong to other linguistic groups.

Pakistan Languages and Literature

National and Official Languages:

2. National Language: Urdu

- Urdu is the **national language of Pakistan** and serves as a **symbol of national unity and Muslim identity**. It was adopted as the national language after independence because it was widely understood across different regions.
- Key points:
- Mother tongue of a small percentage of population (around 7–9%).
- However, it is understood by most Pakistanis as a **second language**.
- Written in **Perso-Arabic script**.
- Widely used in media, literature, and communication.

Official language of Pakistan:

- English is the **official language of Pakistan** and is used in:
- Government administration
- Judiciary and legislation
- Higher education, Civil services and business
- Pakistan's constitution and many official documents are written in English.

Major Regional Languages of Pakistan:

3. Punjabi:

- **Largest language of Pakistan.**
- Spoken mainly in **Punjab province.**
- Around **36–44% of the population** speaks Punjabi.
- Written mostly in **Shahmukhi script** in Pakistan Rich literary tradition including Sufi poetry (**Bulleh Shah, Waris Shah**).

4. Pashto:

- Main language of **Khyber Pakhtunkhwa** and parts of Balochistan.
- Spoken by about **18% of Pakistan's population.**
- Belongs to the **Iranian branch of Indo-European languages.**
- Important poets include **Khushal Khan Khattak** and **Rahman Baba.**

5. Sindhi:

- Provincial language of **Sindh**.
- One of the **oldest literary languages of South Asia**.
- Written in **Arabic-based Sindhi script**.
- Famous poets include **Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai** and **Sachal Sarmast**

6. Saraiki:

- Spoken mainly in **Southern Punjab** (Multan, Bahawalpur, Dera Ghazi Khan).
- About **10–12% of the population** speaks Saraiki.
- Close linguistic relation with Punjabi but recognized as a separate language.

7. Balochi:

- Main language of **Baluchistan**.
- Belongs to the **Iranian language group**.
- Rich oral tradition including folk poetry and epic narratives.
- **Other Important Regional Languages:**
 - Besides major languages, several other languages are spoken:
 - Hindko (KP and Hazara region)
 - Brahui (Baluchistan)
 - Kashmiri, Balti, Shina
 - Burushaski, Khowar
- These languages represent Pakistan's **ethnic and cultural diversity**.

Importance of Urdu as a National Language:

- Urdu was chosen as the national language because:
- It was associated with the **Muslim identity of the subcontinent.**
- It had a **rich literary and cultural heritage.**
- It could serve as a **link language among diverse ethnic groups.**
- It promoted **national integration and unity.**

Major Regional Languages with Famous Poets:

1. Punjabi

- Largest spoken language in Pakistan.
- **Waris Shah** (1722–1798) – Author of *Heer Ranjha*.
- **Bulleh Shah** (1680–1757) – Famous Sufi poet.

2. Pashto

- Spoken in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and northern Balochistan.

3. Khushal Khan Khattak (1613–1689).

- **Rahman Baba** (1653–1711)

4. Sindhi

- Language of Sindh with an ancient literary tradition.
- **Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai** (1689–1752).
- **Sachal Sarmast** (1739–1829).

5. Saraiki

- Spoken in Southern Punjab.
- **Khawaja Ghulam Farid** (1845–1901).
- **Sachal Sarmast** (1739–1829).

6. Balochi

- Spoken in Balochistan.
- **Jam Durrak** (18th Century).
- **Gul Khan Naseer** (1914–1983).

Modernization and its impact on society

Civil Society of Pakistan:

What is Civil Society?

- Civil society means **organizations and groups that work for the welfare of people and operate independently from the government.**
- These organizations help improve society and protect the rights of citizens.
- A famous sociologist who explained the importance of social institutions and social cooperation was **Émile Durkheim.**

Modernization and its impact on society

Examples of Civil Society in Pakistan:

- Civil society includes:
- NGOs (Non-Governmental Organizations)
- Human rights organizations
- Welfare foundations
- Media organizations
- Professional associations
- Educational institutions
- These groups help society in **education, health, justice, and public awareness.**

- **Role of Civil Society in Pakistan:**

- 1. Promotion of Democracy**

Civil society encourages people to participate in democratic processes.

- 2. Protection of Human Rights**

It raises awareness about the rights of women, minorities, and poor people.

- 3. Social Welfare**

Many organizations work for education, health, and poverty reduction.

- 4. Public Awareness**

Civil society informs people about social problems like corruption and injustice.

Modernization and Its Impact on Pakistani Society:

- **What is Modernization?**
- Modernization means **the process through which society changes due to education, technology, industry, and urban development.**

Positive Effects:

- **Better education system**
- **More economic opportunities**
- **Increased role of women in society**
- **Improved communication and technology**
- **Growth of cities and industries**

Negative Effects:

- Weakening of **traditional values**
- Influence of **Western culture**
- Increase in **social inequality**
- Change from **joint family system to nuclear family**

Sociology Concepts by Émile Durkheim

- **Three Famous Books:**
- The Division of Labour in Society
- Suicide
- The Elementary Forms of Religious Life

Main Concepts

- **Social Facts** – rules and traditions that guide behavior
- **Collective Conscience** – shared beliefs and values of society
- **Social Solidarity** – unity that keeps society stable

Types of solidarity:

- **Mechanical Solidarity** – traditional societies
- **Organic Solidarity** – modern societies

Solidarity in Sociology:

- **Solidarity** means the **unity, cooperation, and sense of belonging among members of a society**.
It helps people live together peacefully and follow common rules and values.
- The concept of solidarity was explained by the French sociologist **Émile Durkheim**.

Types of Social Solidarity:

- **1. Mechanical Solidarity**
- Found in **traditional societies**
- People have **similar work, beliefs, and lifestyles**
- Unity based on **tradition and religion**
- **Example:** Tribal or village societies

- **2. Organic Solidarity:**
- Found in **modern industrial societies**
- People have **different jobs and roles**
- Unity based on **mutual dependence**
- **Example:** Modern cities and industrial societies